‘Disturbing and pathetic’: German politicians slam Audi CEO’s appearance at Trump rally

送信者: POLITICO Pro Mobility 受信日時: 2026-10-26 21:03

【要点】

・アウディのゲルノット・デルナー最高経営責任者がトランプ米大統領のキャンペーン集会に登場し、ドイツの政治家から厳しく批判されている。

・デルナーは集会でアウディが米国に約40億ドルを投資して新工場を建設し、初めて米国で自動車生産を行うと発表し、トランプ大統領の舞台で謝意を述べた。

・ドイツの社民党議員や中道右派キリスト教民主同盟の議員は、デルナーの行動を「独裁者を積極的に応援する行為」「不当な政治利用」として非難し、トランプ政権の対ドイツ通商戦争政策を助長していると指摘している。

・ドイツ最大の産業労働組合IG Metallは、デルナーが企業の政治的中立性方針に違反しており、アウディの従業員にも失礼であると強く抗議している。

・アウディは声明で米国での投資は成長戦略の一環であり長期的な約束だと述べているが、フォルクスワーゲンは今年の決算でトランプ政権の関税が悪影響を及ぼしていると述べている。

【メール原文】

German politicians have sharply criticized Audi CEO Gernot Döllner's appearance alongside U.S. President Donald Trump at a campaign rally on Saturday.
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‘Disturbing and pathetic’: German politicians slam Audi CEO’s appearance at Trump rally
By Sonja Rijnen · Oct 26, 2026, 1:02 PM · View in your browser

German politicians have sharply criticized Audi CEO Gernot Döllner’s appearance alongside U.S. President Donald Trump at a campaign rally on Saturday.

“Actively campaigning for an autocrat who is waging a trade war against Germany marks a new low for the VW Group,” said Isabel Cademartori, a Social Democratic Party lawmaker and the party’s transport policy spokesperson.

“This is a disgrace,” she added, “especially considering the history of the VW Group.” Audi is a subsidiary of Volkswagen, which was founded in 1937 by the Nazi Party’s German Labor Front. Cademartori went on to accuse Audi of “validating Trump’s strategy” of “using a trade war to shift jobs from Europe to the United States.”

At the rally in the U.S. state of Georgia, Trump announced Audi plans to invest around $4 billion to build a new factory and begin producing cars in the U.S. for the first time. Döllner joined Trump on stage and thanked him for his support.

The announcement comes as Volkswagen faces a deep crisis amid a major restructuring in Germany, with factory closures and mass layoffs expected .

MEP Dennis Radtke from the center-right Christian Democratic Union party also lambasted Döllner's appearance at the Republican campaign rally. "Donald Trump's policies are massively damaging German industry, including the automotive industry," he told German media outlet Handelsblatt .

"The fact that German companies invest abroad is initially a completely normal and understandable process. However, to turn this into an election campaign staging for Donald Trump is disturbing and pathetic," he added.

German union leaders joined in the condemnation of Döllner. Christiane Benner, first chair of IG Metall, Germany's biggest industrial trade union, said Monday: "The way in which Gernot Döllner presented himself and Audi in the USA is highly embarrassing, politically unacceptable, and unworthy of the company — and, above all, unworthy of the people who work at Audi.

"Döllner is flagrantly violating the company's own internal policies, which explicitly mandate political neutrality in the lead-up to elections," she added.

In a statement released Sunday, Audi said the "U.S. offers considerable growth potential for Audi. Local production is a central component of a comprehensive growth strategy." The company added that "the planned investment is a long-term commitment to the United States."

Earlier this year, Volkswagen CEO Oliver Blume blamed the firm's worst financial results in a decade partially on tariffs imposed by the Trump administration.

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